

DEVOTIONAL GUIDE

A Life of Prayer

Seven days of Scripture-shaped attention, communion and intercession.

Editorial preview edition - prepared for ministry review

How to use this guide

Set aside 15-20 quiet minutes each day. Read slowly, sit with one question and complete the practice. The goal is not volume but a more attentive life with God.

A simple rhythm

Read the listed passages in your preferred Bible translation. Notice what the text reveals about God, people and faithful response. Discuss without rushing. Choose one practice for the week. Return to the next session ready to share what changed.

Important note

This is an original editorial formation guide, not a substitute for pastoral care or a final doctrinal statement. Scripture references are provided without reproduced translation text so readers can use an approved translation.

Day 1 - Arrive

Scripture pathway: Psalm 46; Matthew 11:28-30

Core idea

Prayer begins by becoming present to the God who is already present. We bring the life we actually have, not the life we wish we could display.

Reflect together

1. What noise are you carrying into prayer?
2. What would honest arrival sound like today?

Practise this

Sit in silence for three minutes. Name what is present without trying to solve it.

Prayer direction

God, I arrive as I am. Quiet what is false and awaken me to your presence.

Day 2 - Listen

Scripture pathway: 1 Samuel 3:1-10; John 10:1-5

Core idea

Listening is not passivity. It is trained attention shaped by Scripture, humility and a willingness to obey what is good.

Reflect together

1. What competes most strongly for your attention?
2. How can Scripture test what you think you hear?

Practise this

Read one passage aloud twice. Record the phrase that invites faithful response.

Prayer direction

Speak, Lord. Give me humility to listen and wisdom to recognise your truth.

Day 3 - Ask

Scripture pathway: Matthew 6:5-13; Philippians 4:4-7

Core idea

Petition brings real need before God without performance. Jesus teaches prayer that reorders desire around God's name, Kingdom, provision, mercy and protection.

Reflect together

1. Which request in the Lord's Prayer do you avoid?
2. What need can you name plainly today?

Practise this

Write five requests in one sentence each. Leave space beneath them to record perspective, not only outcomes.

Prayer direction

Father, give what is needed, reorder what is wanted and keep me faithful while I wait.

Day 4 - Confess

Scripture pathway: Psalm 51:1-12; 1 John 1:5-9

Core idea

Confession is truthful return. It refuses both hiding and despair because mercy makes honest change possible.

Reflect together

1. What are you tempted to minimise?
2. What repair may need to follow confession?

Practise this

Name one specific failure without excuse. Identify one person or practice involved in repair.

Prayer direction

Merciful God, bring me into the light. Clean what is distorted and restore a willing spirit.

Day 5 - Give thanks

Scripture pathway: Psalm 103:1-5; Luke 17:11-19

Core idea

Gratitude trains attention to recognise gift, grace and sustaining mercy. It resists entitlement without denying grief.

Reflect together

1. Which ordinary gift have you stopped noticing?
2. How can gratitude coexist with lament?

Practise this

Record ten concrete gifts from the last twenty-four hours. Thank one person directly.

Prayer direction

Giver of every good gift, keep my heart awake to grace and generous in response.

Day 6 - Intercede

Scripture pathway: 1 Timothy 2:1-6; Ephesians 3:14-21

Core idea

Intercession carries people and places before God with love. It expands prayer beyond private concerns and teaches patient solidarity.

Reflect together

1. Who is easy for you to forget?
2. Which public concern needs sustained rather than reactive prayer?

Practise this

Pray through five circles: household, community, leaders, those suffering and the Church.

Prayer direction

God of all people, widen my concern and teach me to carry others with hope.

Day 7 - Remain

Scripture pathway: John 15:4-11; Colossians 4:2-6

Core idea

A life of prayer is built through return. Faithfulness grows through small rhythms that keep communion connected to speech, work and relationships.

Reflect together

1. Which practice from this week is sustainable?
2. What time and place will help you return?

Practise this

Design a simple weekly rhythm: a daily moment, a weekly longer space and one shared prayer practice.

Prayer direction

Christ, teach me to remain. Let prayer become attention, obedience and love throughout ordinary life.

Continue the journey

Growth becomes durable when reflection turns into repeated practice. Revisit the session that most challenged you, share one insight with a trusted person and choose one faithful action to continue for the next thirty days.

Know. Become. Belong. Serve. Influence.

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